



The Changing Face Of India's Defence Sector In Perspective

India is one of the largest importers of defence equipment worldwide. However, the government is now planning to reduce the country's dependence on imports with focus on indigenous production of defence equipment. With a slew of recently announced reforms, the defence sector will surely gain more momentum in its path to self-reliance in defence production



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India is one of the largest importers of defence equipment in the world. Imports account for 60-65 per cent of the country's military requirements, which are being met by foreign suppliers. In a significant move, the government seeks to reduce electronics import with focus on indigenous production of defence equip-

ment. This will encourage increased participation of the private sector in defence manufacturing. With a slew of reforms recently announced by the government, including banning the import of weapons that can be made in the country, corporatisation of Ordnance Factory Board (OFB), and raising foreign direct investment (FDI) in

defence manufacturing to 74 per cent from 49 per cent, the defence sector will surely gain more momentum in its path to self-reliance in defence production.

In tandem with current developments in the defence sector, a webinar titled 'Defence Electronics—Policy Focus on Domestic Manufacturing,